

(4.3-inch) screen now.

Interactive TV shopping

Flipping through catalogue pages is much easier than using the remote control to navigate an online menu. Realising this, BNS, Asia's IPTV technology and content solutions provider, has launched a multimedia solution that combines IPTV technology with invisible dot-code printing and recognition technology.

BNS Touch is a TV shopping system that converges the browsing convenience of printed information



The Wiz device from BNS Touch

with the information-rich multimedia experience of the online world. Linking the printed with the online/TV world is The Wiz—a pen-like device equipped with a small infrared camera and a sensor that brings items in a printed catalogue to life on the TV screen. The Wiz is available in a wired or wireless version for maximum application flexibility.

Working behind the scenes is a BNS-developed backend management system that includes content management, subscriber database integration, payment gateway, and an inventory and logistics interface. This allows the shopping-on-demand system to integrate with existing IPTV services and shopping catalogues.

USB adaptor for file transfer without PC

Elan Digital Systems has launched a matchbox-sized Mobidapter that plugs straight into the SD slot found on Panasonic TVs allowing you to transfer photos and films stored on a standard

USB stick in minutes.

No PC or laptop connections, no driver software and no power supply are needed. The Panasonic TV's software simply recognises the SD card and the stored data in the USB stick is instantly transferred via the Mobidapter.

The Mobidapter is compatible with virtually all SD- and USB-compliant products and measures 3.5×7.5×1 cm³.

Virtual desktops

LG Electronics is going to embed virtualisation technology from US-based NComputing into its LCD monitors, enabling up to eleven people to share a single PC.

NComputing's virtualisation technology enables a single PC or server to be virtualised so that many users can tap the unused capacity and share it as if each person had his own computer. The sub-\$200 computing solution will further drive the acceleration towards desktop virtualisation and cloud computing, in which computing is centralised and done over the Web.

The new category of LCD monitors, called SmartVine N-series, will work with both Windows and Linux computers. Users can connect their keyboards and mice directly to the monitor, which will then connect to the host PC via a standard cable. An NComputing X550 PCI card kit with vSpace software will enable the host PC to connect to five additional monitors. With two kits, a total of eleven users can share one PC.

VoIP plug-in for Microsoft fax

Thanks to a VoIP plug-in from a company called FaxBack, Windows OS users can now send and receive faxes using Microsoft Fax when connected to a VoIP phone system. This capability was previously unachievable without expensive or complex hardware configurations, as per FaxBack.

Routing inbound faxes to specific users with DID routing is straight-

forward with the Free Edition of the VoIP plug-in for Microsoft Fax. By adding routing rules on their local VoIP media gateway, users will be able to automatically route inbound faxes directly to the intended recipients' desktops.

Users can also install the VoIP plug-in for Microsoft Fax on their Microsoft Small Business Server to provide a VoIP fax server that is always available to receive faxes.

The free plug-in is available at www.faxback.com/msfax/release.

Solar-powered mobile phones

Charge your mobile anywhere the Sun is shining when electricity is unavailable. Samsung has introduced a solar-powered mobile phone, the Solar Guru (Guru E1107), in India. However, the solar power charging is only an option and not the main mode of charging. To charge the battery fully via the solar panel, the phone needs to be kept in the Sun for 40 hours. The Solar Guru can provide around five to 10 minutes of talk time with one hour of solar charging.



Samsung Solar Guru E1107

Earlier, a Chinese manufacturer had also announced a solar-powered cell phone. It claimed that placing the phone under strong sunlight for one hour would support 15 minutes of talk time and about eight hours exposure to strong sunlight was required to fully charge the cell phone. Japanese electronics company Sharp is also planning to launch its solar-powered phone SH002, which can give one minute of talk time and two hours of standby